1973). The tensions involved in achieving containment were huge even though they were – and still are – temporary.[13]

It was a question of implementing political forms that were able to ensure the spread of value appropriation with a permanent supply of the newly expropriated labour force under new, highly internationalised conditions. For this, several fields of study were created to absorb and to 'specialise' disparate international tensions (for example, unemployment in the centre and super-exploitation in the periphery), maintaining state controls over popular masses.[14] Democracy is now reduced almost totally to the judicial-electoral moment, freed from every connection to 'welfare'. State enclosure of social struggles intensifies, affecting workers' autonomous capacity to organise, extending even to erasing the very perception of an ever growing, unequal, yet intimately associated working class organised on an international scale. Secondary expropriations, especially those that take away worker contractual rights (outsourcings and casualisations), act upon the material basis for reproducing life. They dilute comprehension of this process by naturalising the urgency for health, home and food. At the same time, the 'new poor' emerges without a sense of belonging to the working class.

Liberal thought labels social organisations with the term Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs). Well, under capitalism this is the classic terrain of class struggle and, therefore, also of dominant class organisation nationally and internationally. In a rich and complex way, Antonio Gramsci analysed the private hegemonic structures, or civil society, as integrating the state and the part essential to decision-making, which the term NGO obscures and erases (Gramsci 2001; Fontes 2009). The present modifications of the political sphere not only refer to dominant sector manoeuvrings but also to a certain alteration in the clash of intense social struggles.

Both globally and in the Brazilian case, the opposition to multiplying popular demands seeks to prevent their political unity (on national and international levels) by means of stimulating a supposedly 'apolitical' specialisation, which the term NGO helps to reinforce. Its efficacy consists in actualising the conversion of popular processes of organising demands into bodies specialised in targeted social policies made possible by the 'donation' of resources controlled by business groups (national, international or mainly different associated bourgeoisies) or directly through public funding (Pereira 2011).

Grassroots political activity is dispersed, fragmented over different territories; it is economically controlled by business (or philanthropic) sectors and overburdened by combating innumerable problems, while acting locally and palliatively. Therefore, the main consequence is a section of sub-national